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EU AI Act

Finland

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AI & Partners defends and extends the digital rights of users at risk around the world. By combining direct technical support, comprehensive policy engagement, global advocacy, grassroots professional services, regulatory interventions, and participating in industry groups such as AI Commons, we fight for fundamental rights in the artificial intelligence age.

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Who Are We

AI That You Can Trust

Why Us?

Stay on the right side of history. At AI & Partners, we believe AI should unlock potential—not cause harm. We’ve seen the fear and fallout when teams lose control of AI, but also the trust and innovation that follow when it’s handled responsibly. That’s why we exist: to help you build AI you can trust and stand behind—for the long run.

80%

of AI systems
are unknown

What Do We Do?

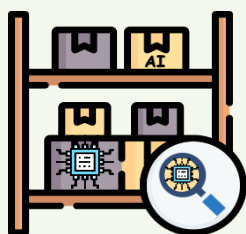
We enable safe AI usage—for your organization and your clients. Unknown AI adoption leads to confusion, risk, and reputational damage. We help you take control with tools to identify, monitor, and govern all AI systems—so you're not reacting to AI, you're leading it.



How Do We Do It?

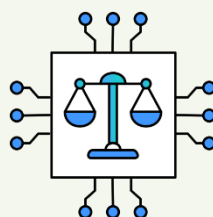
Do you know what AI systems you have? Identify all known and unknown AI systems (algorithms, LLMs, prompts, and models) from all internal and external AI vendors, automated by generating your inventory. Overall, 80% of AI inventory is unknown to our clients.

How do you guarantee ongoing safe AI use? Continuously monitor deployed AI systems for performance drift, anomalies or failures, real-world impacts, and emerging risks (e.g. data poisoning). Any malfunction of an AI system has severe implications for organisations (e.g. inability to assess online misinformation that leads to widespread public mistrust), so monitoring becomes a matter of urgency.



AI Discovery & AI Inventory

Automatically detect all AI systems, including models, algorithms, and prompts, and maintain a live, always-updated register for full visibility and compliance.



Responsible AI

Embed fairness, transparency, and control into every stage of AI use—aligning with the EU AI Act and building ‘Trustworthy-by-Design’.



Model Monitoring

Continuously track your AI models after deployment to detect drift, bias, or failure—so you stay in control and prevent harm before it happens.



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Overview

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is emerging as a transformative force across Finland's economy and society, with the country adopting a pragmatic and innovation-oriented approach to its governance. Rather than developing standalone national legislation, Finland is aligning closely with the European Union's AI Act, while supporting implementation through national strategies, public sector frameworks, and ethical guidelines to promote secure and trustworthy AI development.

At the heart of Finland's AI governance is its adherence to the EU AI Act, which is being integrated into Finnish law through an ongoing legislative process. A government-appointed working group is currently preparing the national implementation plan, which includes designating responsible authorities, adapting existing legislation, and developing an oversight framework. While specific institutions have yet to be formally appointed, Finland is proactively preparing for full compliance with the EU's AI regulatory architecture.

Finland's domestic AI ecosystem is supported by initiatives such as the Artificial Intelligence 4.0 programme, launched in 2020, which aims to drive sustainable growth, enhance productivity, and enable digital transformation in Finnish industry by 2030. Complementary strategic tools such as the National Digital Compass and the Quantum Technology Strategy support broader technology governance goals. Though comprehensive AI regulation is not yet in force, sectoral guidelines—such as those issued by the VAHTI network for public administration—provide ethical and technical best practices, particularly around transparency, privacy, and cybersecurity.

Institutional coordination of AI policy in Finland remains in progress, but agencies such as the Finnish Digital and Population Data Services Agency play a central role in digital governance.

Oversight responsibilities are expected to be clarified during the implementation phase of the EU AI Act. Finland's data protection framework—anchored in GDPR compliance—is a critical element in governing AI-related use of personal data, and recent enforcement cases have demonstrated the government's commitment to lawful and ethical AI deployment.

Internationally, Finland is an active proponent of rules-based, ethical AI development. As an EU member state and signatory to multilateral frameworks like the OECD AI Principles, Finland advances a human-centric vision of AI that safeguards democratic values and digital rights. The Finnish government also engages in cross-border collaboration through EU mechanisms and contributes to global discourse on AI policy and law. Finland's AI governance strategy also considers liability, civil responsibility, and data protection. In the absence of bespoke AI laws, liability is currently governed under product liability, tort law, and GDPR, with anticipated updates through the forthcoming AI Liability Directive. Discussions around intellectual property, data scraping, and employment law further highlight the multi-dimensional implications of AI, particularly in the legal sector, where adoption remains moderate but growing.

Through a blend of EU harmonization, strategic national programs, and evolving legal adaptation, Finland is crafting an AI governance framework that supports technological innovation while embedding ethical and legal safeguards. As the EU AI Act enters into force, Finland's focus will be on implementation, institution building, and ensuring that AI advances are both trusted and transformative. This report explores Finland's dynamic AI policy landscape and outlines how one of Europe's most digitally advanced nations is preparing for the future of responsible AI.





Specific AI Governance or Law

Finland has no standalone AI law but is preparing to implement the EU AI Act, with some provisions already in effect. A national working group is reviewing legal updates and oversight roles. Existing laws on data protection, public administration, and employment already cover certain AI uses, including automated decision-making.

Specific AI Governance in Finland

Finland has not enacted standalone national legislation specifically targeting artificial intelligence. Instead, as a committed EU Member State, Finland will implement the EU AI Act, which establishes a harmonized regulatory regime for AI systems across the Union. Following the Act's entry into force on August 1, 2024, Finland has begun the process of preparing for full implementation, which is required by 2026. Certain provisions—such as bans on prohibited AI practices and obligations for general-purpose AI systems—will apply sooner, in line with EU timelines. To facilitate national implementation, Finland has appointed a dedicated working group tasked with identifying required legal amendments and allocating supervisory responsibilities among relevant authorities. While no specific AI regulator has yet been designated, this group is expected to propose a governance structure by late 2025. These developments will inform legislative updates and oversight mechanisms to ensure conformity with the EU framework while maintaining administrative proportionality and regulatory clarity. Although Finland lacks AI-specific statutes, AI-related provisions already exist within the legal system—particularly concerning data protection, public sector decision-making, and employment. For example, the use of automated decision-making in public administration has been subject to regulation since 2023. Additionally, labor and privacy laws—such as the Co-operation Act and the Act on the Protection of Privacy in Working Life—apply to workplace AI deployments.

AI Ethics Guidelines and Sectoral Governance Tools

Finland does not yet maintain a unified national ethical framework for AI. However, ethical oversight is guided by government-issued standards and public sector governance instruments. The VAHTI network, which supports digital security in public administration, has published general rules and checklists for responsible AI usage. These materials emphasize transparency, fairness, and data security, particularly within government operations. At the strategic level, the Artificial Intelligence 4.0 programme—launched in 2020—defines Finland's long-term AI vision. The programme emphasizes sustainable digital growth, clean industrial innovation, and ecosystem diversification. Complementary frameworks such as the National Digital Compass and the Quantum Technology Strategy position AI as a driver of productivity and competitiveness. Across these initiatives, human-centricity, data sovereignty, and democratic values are core guiding principles. In the absence of a dedicated AI liability law, existing statutes including the Finnish Product Liability Act, the Tort Liability Act, and the GDPR provide avenues for legal redress in cases involving defective or harmful AI systems. Finland has also acknowledged the need for clarity on AI-related liability and supports the adoption of the proposed EU AI Liability Directive, which aims to ease the evidentiary burden for victims of AI-related harm.

Proposed AI Regulatory Authority and Future Outlook

At the time of writing, Finland has not appointed a single regulator for AI oversight. However, the national working group preparing for the EU AI Act is expected to recommend a supervisory architecture that allocates responsibilities among existing institutions, including those overseeing data protection, labor regulation, and digital services. The Finnish Office of the Data Protection Ombudsman is likely to play a prominent role, especially in addressing privacy risks arising from AI deployments. Finland's approach is marked by proactive legal harmonization and institutional foresight. While courts have not yet ruled on AI-specific cases, the Finnish Deputy Data Protection Ombudsman has addressed unlawful facial recognition practices, highlighting the country's commitment to privacy and lawful AI use. These developments signal an emerging compliance culture and growing awareness of AI-related rights and obligations. Looking ahead, Finland's AI governance will be shaped by the implementation of the EU AI Act, ongoing inter-ministerial coordination, and sector-specific reforms. As AI adoption expands—from business to education to healthcare—Finland's regulatory focus will remain on balancing innovation with accountability. Through targeted legal reform, strategic investment, and values-based oversight, Finland is positioning itself to contribute meaningfully to Europe's trusted and resilient AI ecosystem.



Discussion: Finland's National AI Strategy

'Finland's approach to AI governance is grounded in a pragmatic, values-based vision that emphasises responsible innovation, democratic accountability, and long-term competitiveness. Anchored in the principles of openness, trust, and sustainability, Finland's Artificial Intelligence 4.0 programme is designed not only to enhance productivity and green transformation, but also to promote the public good through structured governance, cross-sector collaboration, and inclusive capacity-building.'

**Nature Smart
Companies**

**Strengthen AI
Leadership**

**Reach Top Positions
in Global AI
Rankings**

**Become An
International AI
Player**

Analysis

Finland's AI strategy is defined by its commitment to embedding artificial intelligence into broader industrial and societal development. Through the Tekoäly 4.0 (Artificial Intelligence 4.0) programme, Finland positions itself as a "winner of the twin transition"—a reference to the parallel challenges of industrial digitalisation and environmental sustainability. This strategy aligns with the EU's regulatory trajectory, including the AI Act, while also promoting national priorities such as data-driven value creation, sovereign technology leadership, and digital inclusion. Central to Finland's vision is its focus on human-centric and green AI. The strategy promotes ethical use of data and emerging technologies, encourages resource-efficient innovation, and supports the convergence of AI with frontier technologies like quantum computing and 6G. Rather than relying solely on regulation, Finland leverages adaptive policy tools and co-created objectives using the OKR (Objectives and Key Results) model, fostering accountability and agility across ministries, research institutions, and the private sector

A key feature of Finland's governance model is its strategic alignment with EU values and global standards. Finland actively contributes to European AI, data, and industrial policy formation and implementation. The strategy commits Finland to strengthening its impact within the EU's digital agenda and supports interoperability with international frameworks including the OECD AI Principles and the UNESCO Recommendation on the Ethics of AI. Finland's approach is grounded in "technological neutrality," yet it acknowledges the growing need for value-based prioritisation in areas such as environmental AI applications and digital infrastructure. This includes exploring leadership roles in areas like edge computing, data stewardship, and AI-enabled manufacturing networks

Finland supports AI experimentation and agile governance through measures such as testing environments, stakeholder-driven policy development, and iterative performance evaluation. The AI 4.0 programme's second interim report highlights the value of cross-sectoral working groups and scenario planning to anticipate future challenges and align strategic investments with measurable outcomes. Although Finland does not yet have formal AI sandboxes, its AI governance encourages modular, feedback-informed experimentation in domains such as high-performance computing (HPC), data economy ecosystems, and sustainable industry pilots. Emerging institutions like a proposed ELLIS (European Laboratory for Learning and Intelligent Systems) centre in Finland are envisioned to attract global talent and reinforce national excellence.

AI governance in Finland is deeply tied to industrial competitiveness and environmental policy. The AI 4.0 programme targets deep integration of AI across priority areas such as smart manufacturing, robotics, and resource optimisation. National objectives include placing Finland among the top six global adopters of industrial AI and robotics and ensuring the scalability of quantum and edge AI through enhanced HPC infrastructure (e.g., via the LUMI supercomputer) Finland also champions public-private partnerships and open data infrastructures. Through initiatives such as sectoral data ecosystems and the GAIA-X framework, Finland seeks to foster trustworthy, interoperable data flows that power ethical AI innovation.

A strong emphasis on digital inclusion and lifelong learning runs through Finland's AI strategy. The country prioritises developing a multidisciplinary AI workforce through investments in vocational training, interdisciplinary university curricula, and talent attraction programmes such as Talent Boost. A dedicated focus is also placed on SME support, regional development, and equitable access to AI-driven benefits



Finland's Approach to AI Regulation and Governance

Finland has adopted a pragmatic, EU-aligned approach to AI governance, grounded in strategic foresight, regulatory harmonisation, and sector-specific implementation. While national AI legislation remains in its formative stages, Finland actively prepares for full implementation of the EU AI Act and complements it with ethical frameworks, institutional collaboration, and digital innovation programs tailored to its technological and societal landscape.

1. Regulatory and Strategic Frameworks

Finland's AI governance is closely integrated within the European Union's regulatory framework. Rather than enacting bespoke national legislation, Finland is preparing to implement the EU AI Act, which will serve as the primary legal framework for AI systems across the EU. As of August 1, 2024, the EU AI Act is in force, with phased obligations becoming applicable over the following two years. To support this, Finland has launched a national working group tasked with coordinating the domestic implementation of the EU AI Act. This group is responsible for proposing legislative amendments, identifying supervisory authorities, and establishing compliance pathways across public and private sectors. While national legislation specific to AI is not yet adopted, provisions in areas such as automated public decision-making and employment regulation already intersect with AI governance. The Artificial Intelligence 4.0 Programme, launched in 2020, remains Finland's cornerstone AI strategy. It outlines a vision of clean, efficient, and digital industry by 2030, with AI positioned as a catalyst for economic renewal and productivity growth.



2. Institutional Support and Strategic Missions

Finland's AI governance is currently coordinated through ministerial collaboration, with the Finnish Ministry of Economic Affairs and Employment, Ministry of Finance, and Ministry of Education and Culture playing key roles. The Office of the Data Protection Ombudsman is expected to assume a central role in regulatory enforcement, particularly concerning privacy and risk-based AI applications. Strategically, AI governance is embedded in broader national initiatives, including Finland's Digital Compass and Quantum Technology Strategy. These frameworks emphasise the secure and sustainable adoption of AI, with a focus on ecosystem diversification, human-centricity, and digital sovereignty. While Finland has yet to formally designate a national AI regulator, institutional coordination is advancing in preparation for the EU AI Act's full application.





3. Standards Development and Global Engagement

Finland contributes actively to the development of EU and international AI standards, working within frameworks established by the European Commission, the OECD, and ISO/IEC committees. Domestically, the VAHTI network—a public sector digital security body—has published practical AI guidelines, including risk checklists and principles of transparency and accountability. Although Finland has not yet issued national AI ethics legislation, public authorities and research institutions engage in shaping ethical guidance, particularly on data governance and algorithmic fairness. Finland also advocates for the adoption of the EU AI Liability Directive to clarify legal redress mechanisms in cases of AI-induced harm.

4. Sectoral and Extended Regulatory Approaches

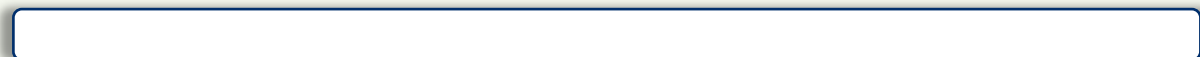
AI deployment in Finland is increasingly subject to sectoral regulation and horizontal legal frameworks. Public sector use of AI has been governed since 2023 through laws addressing automated decision-making. Employment law instruments such as the Co-operation Act and the Act on the Protection of Privacy in Working Life regulate the use of AI in the workplace. While these provisions are not AI-specific, they provide important guardrails for algorithmic decision-making, surveillance, and data processing. In the private sector, GDPR compliance remains a foundational legal obligation for AI systems involving personal data.

5. Fostering Innovation and Indigenous Development

Finland views AI as a strategic technology for national competitiveness and sustainability. Under the Artificial Intelligence 4.0 Programme and broader Finland 2030 digitalisation goals, the government is investing in research, public-private partnerships, and pilot projects to scale AI innovation across sectors. SMEs are supported through tailored funding schemes, accelerator programmes, and guidance initiatives aimed at bridging the innovation gap. While uptake of AI remains modest—only 17% of large companies reported structured AI use by late 2023—adoption is expected to accelerate due to increased availability of generative AI tools and ecosystem support.

6. AI in Public Sector Transformation

AI is playing an increasing role in transforming Finland’s public administration. The government has introduced legal obligations for transparency in public sector AI use, and public agencies are actively testing AI in service delivery, document analysis, and administrative decision-making. The VAHTI network’s governance models aim to ensure that such deployments uphold ethical standards, protect fundamental rights, and remain accountable to citizens. The evolving regulatory framework under the EU AI Act will formalise these requirements and establish oversight procedures tailored to public sector contexts.





7. AI Skills, Education and Inclusion

Finland emphasises human capital development in its AI strategy, with a strong focus on education, upskilling, and ethical literacy. AI-specific training is being incorporated into universities, vocational curricula, and public administration programmes. Efforts to reduce inequality in digital skills and expand interdisciplinary AI education are underway, ensuring that workers and citizens can actively participate in an AI-enabled society. Training initiatives also aim to equip legal professionals, regulators, and developers with competencies necessary for AI compliance and ethical design.

8. Infrastructure, Compute and Data Foundations

To enable effective AI deployment, Finland is investing in digital infrastructure, secure data access frameworks, and emerging regulatory tools such as AI sandboxes. While no sandbox is yet formalised, the EU AI Act will require Finland to establish mechanisms for real-world testing under regulatory oversight. Finland's digital infrastructure priorities include enhancing data availability while protecting privacy through GDPR-aligned practices. Although AI liability insurance remains underdeveloped, private insurers are exploring policy offerings, particularly for high-risk sectors and professional indemnity.



Through harmonisation with the EU AI Act, targeted national initiatives, and strong institutional foresight, Finland is constructing an AI governance model that prioritises ethical integrity, technological innovation, and societal trust. As legislative and institutional capacities mature, Finland is poised to play a leading role in shaping an inclusive, human-centric, and innovation-driven AI future within the European Union.





Finland's Approach to Fostering AI Innovation

Finland's AI Strategy strengthens the nation's commitment to digital and green transformation by integrating high-level research, industrial collaboration, and ethical innovation into its AI development. The Tekoäly 4.0 programme aims to make Finland a leader in the twin transition—digitally advanced and environmentally sustainable—through targeted technological investments and ecosystem-wide collaboration.

1. Unlocking Economic Value through Strategic AI Deployment

Finland's AI 4.0 programme accelerates AI adoption in manufacturing, telecommunications, and sustainable development. By supporting pilot projects and test environments, and promoting green and digital innovations, Finland positions itself as a frontrunner in creating economic value aligned with climate goals. Specific actions include boosting datatalous (data-driven value creation), strengthening Edge AI in ICT sectors, and improving SME digital capabilities.



2. Driving Innovation via Research Clusters and Application Hubs

Finland fosters regional excellence through institutions like the Finnish Center for Artificial Intelligence (FCAI) and proposals to join the ELLIS network. Research and innovation are closely tied to industrial applications, especially in 5G/6G convergence with AI. Public-private collaborations develop scalable portfolios and testbeds, integrating AI into critical sectors like manufacturing and energy.

3. Enabling Trusted and Responsible Data Use

With initiatives such as national data platforms and GAIA-X participation, Finland promotes ethical, interoperable data infrastructures. The country supports sectoral data ecosystems, enhanced data literacy, and emerging data intermediary roles, reinforcing trust and sovereignty while enabling innovation across public and private sectors.

4. Scaling AI in Public Administration

The programme emphasizes AI's role in boosting sustainability and digital transformation in public services. Investments in green transition technologies are supported by government policy and funding instruments, and public administration is encouraged to adopt AI-enabled monitoring, reporting, and policy design tools.





5. Advancing Compute and Research Infrastructure

Finland invests significantly in high-performance and quantum computing through CSC's Lumi supercomputer and related infrastructures. These facilities are made accessible to businesses, research institutions, and universities, promoting AI development across disciplines. National funding supports integration of HPC into industrial innovation chains.

6. Empowering SMEs and Startups

Through partnerships with Business Finland and industry networks, Finland lowers adoption barriers by funding experimentation and promoting peer learning. AI toolkits and digital readiness assessments help SMEs embrace AI, while special emphasis is placed on green tech and ESG-driven business models.

7. Developing a Future-Ready Workforce

AI education spans from basic education to university degrees and lifelong learning. Multidisciplinary curricula, industry-academia cooperation, and international talent attraction (e.g., Talent Boost Finland) ensure a robust talent pipeline. Emphasis is also placed on AI literacy and ethical competencies.

8. Aligning AI with Sustainability Goals

The strategy embeds AI into Finland's response to climate change. AI is used to drive resource efficiency, promote sustainable business practices, and enhance ESG reporting. Support is directed toward low-carbon innovation, including green AI infrastructure and circular economy applications.

9. Building Public Trust and Ethical AI

Finland's approach is rooted in transparency, inclusion, and democratic values. Efforts include integrating AI ethics into education, developing open reporting standards for sustainability, and engaging stakeholders in defining responsible AI use, reflecting Finland's tradition of trust-based governance.

10. Shaping Global AI Governance and Standards

Finland actively contributes to EU and international policy through "small engine" leadership in key ecosystems. The country supports harmonized AI regulation and invests in international standardization, particularly in edge computing and sustainability-aligned AI.

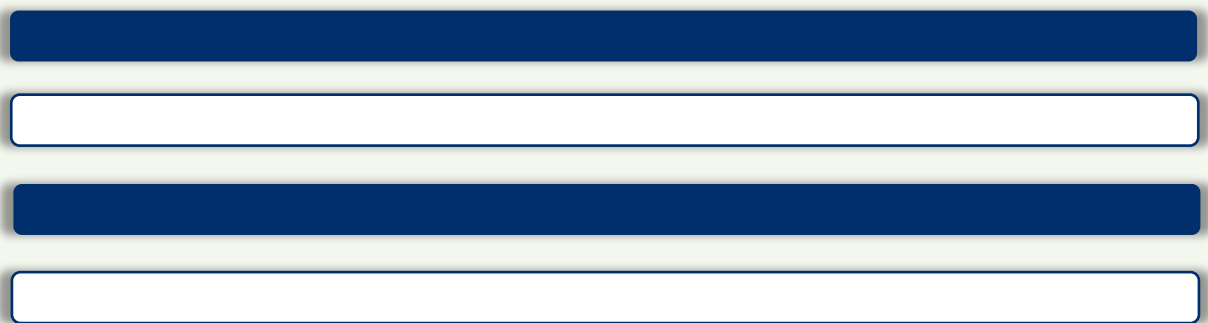
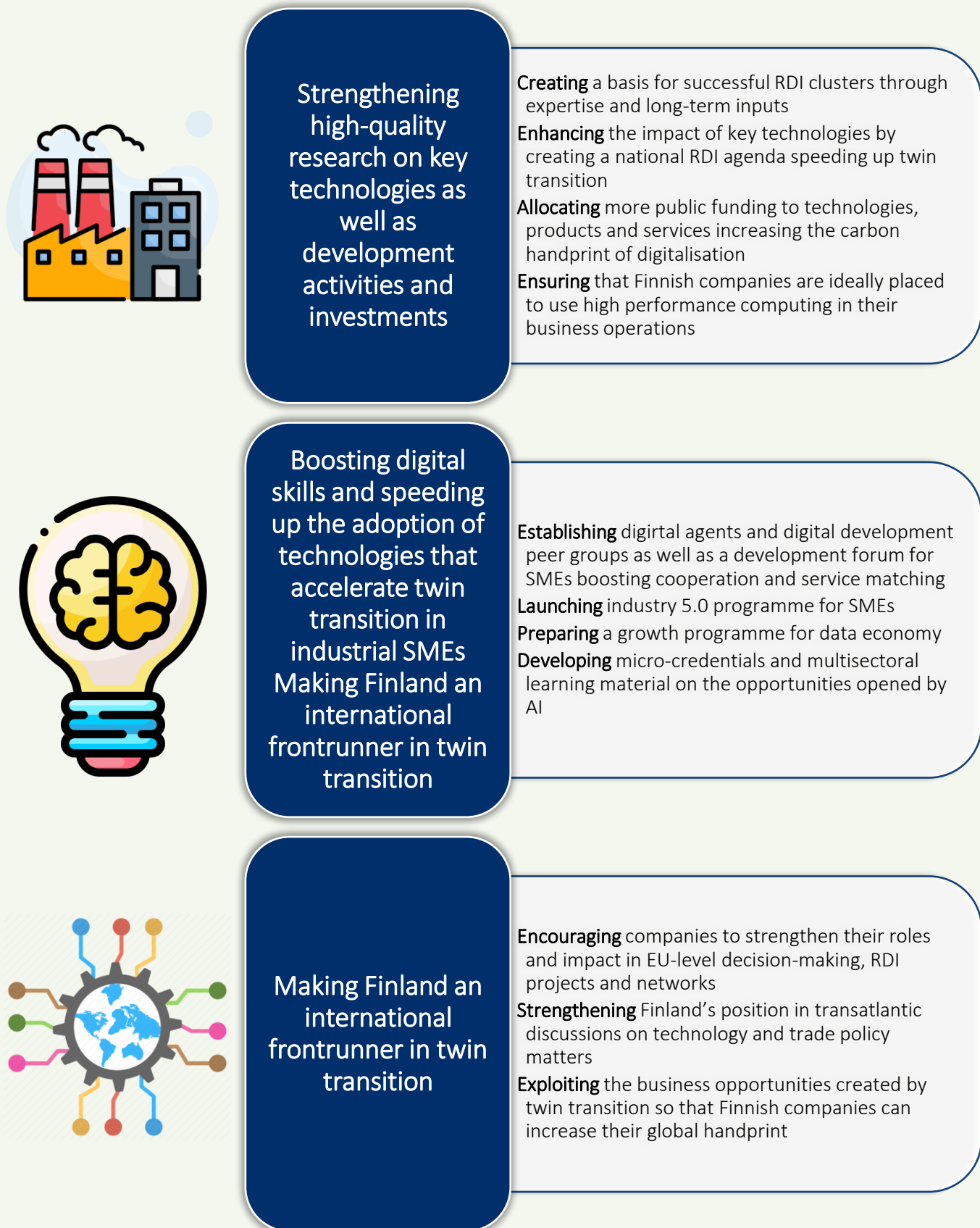




Figure 1: Development priorities of Finland's 4.0 programme





Digital Decade 2025: Country Report

Finland is at the forefront of AI efforts in the EU and is working toward its 75% AI adoption target by 2030.

In 2024, Finland was selected to host one of the European AI Factories. The LUMI AI initiative represents a total investment of EUR 614 million—EUR 306 million from the EU, EUR 250 million in national funding, and the remainder from other consortium members: Czechia, Denmark, Estonia, Norway, and Poland. LUMI AI Factory services began in April 2025, leveraging the current LUMI EuroHPC supercomputer in Kajaani. Its successor, the LUMI+ AI-optimised supercomputer, will become operational later in 2025.

Key focus areas of the Finnish AI Factory include:

- Manufacturing industries
- Health and life sciences
- Communication technologies and networks
- Digital twins
- AI for science

Finland benefits from strong research and innovation partnerships:

- The Finnish Centre for Artificial Intelligence (FCAI), a national RDI Flagship, brings together leading experts from Aalto University, University of Helsinki, and VTT Technical Research Centre.
- The ELLIS Institute was established in December 2024 to foster top-tier AI research, large-scale R&D collaboration, and ethical AI development. The ELLIS Unit Helsinki, hosted by FCAI, is expected to become a world-class AI research hub.
- Over 20 top companies, the Technology Industries of Finland, the Confederation of Finnish Industries, and all Research Council of Finland Flagship projects back the ELLIS Institute Finland initiative.
- A direct link between LUMI AI and ELLIS, provided by FCAI, will enable collaboration and synergies.

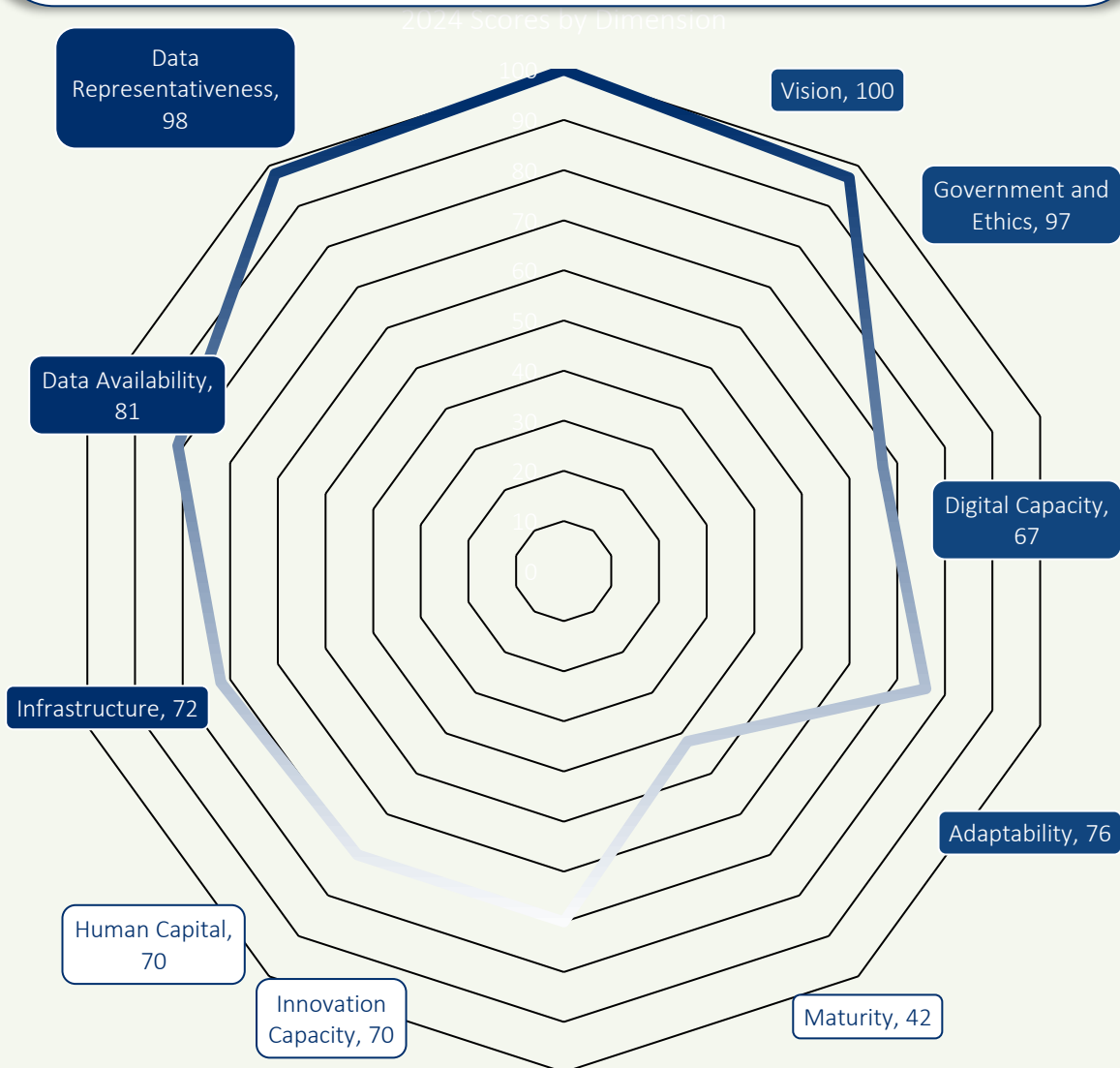
The Technology Industries of Finland will act as the business interface of the AI Factory. The AI Finland network, launched in March 2024, connects Finnish companies and organisations interested in AI. Nearly 400 companies have already joined. The network aims to increase the adoption and development of AI in the country. 2024 policy recommendation on AI: Encourage enterprises to apply existing advanced technologies, such as AI and quantum testing, and continue to innovate. Finland has responded to this recommendation with new policies in 2024. The LUMI AI Factory is intended to bring together key stakeholders, strengthen collaboration, and support HPC and AI projects. It complements other major AI investments—such as the FCAI Flagship, ELLIS Institute, and doctoral training pilots—and promotes the use of AI and advanced tech by the private sector.





Government AI Readiness by Oxford Insights

Western Europe ranks as the highest-performing region in this year's Government AI Readiness Index, with five countries in the global top 10. France leads the regional ranking with a score of 79.36, narrowly ahead of the United Kingdom (78.88), followed closely by the Netherlands (77.23), Germany (76.90), and Finland (76.48). With an average regional score of 69.56, Western Europe outperforms the global average (47.59) across all three pillars of Government, Technology, and Data & Infrastructure. The region's standout strength is the Data & Infrastructure pillar, where it averages 81.91, more than 21 points above the global benchmark (59.62), reflecting its advanced digital infrastructure and high-quality data environment. Although a few microstates such as San Marino, Liechtenstein, and Andorra fall slightly below the global average in the Government pillar, Western Europe's dominance at the top of the index underscores its continued leadership in AI readiness.





Government

Finland scores 84.86 in the Government pillar, one of the highest globally, reflecting the country's proactive and coordinated approach to AI governance. The national Artificial Intelligence 4.0 Programme demonstrates Finland's ambition to lead the twin transition—digital and green—by integrating AI into industrial policy and sustainable innovation. The programme applies an OKR-based strategic management framework and engages diverse stakeholders through thematic working groups. With strong public sector leadership, ethical guidelines, and an inclusive governance model, Finland ensures AI contributes to productivity, resilience, and societal well-being. Its transparent policy-making and support for AI-driven public services reinforce trust and accountability in government-led digital transformation.

Technology Sector

Finland achieves a Technology pillar score of 60.86, underscoring a solid but evolving foundation for AI-driven innovation. National initiatives like Business Finland's AI support programmes and investments in 5G/6G research place Finland at the frontier of telecom-AI integration. Institutions such as FCAI and partnerships with the proposed ELLIS network foster cutting-edge research and talent development. However, the country continues to face challenges scaling entrepreneurial AI ventures, particularly among SMEs. The government's focus on lowering adoption barriers, promoting Edge AI, and enhancing digital skills across sectors supports Finland's push toward a competitive, future-ready AI ecosystem.



Data & infrastructure Sector

With a Data & Infrastructure score of 83.73, Finland stands out for its advanced digital environment and emphasis on secure, sovereign data practices. The country promotes sector-specific data ecosystems and supports interoperability with EU-wide initiatives like GAIA-X. High-performance computing infrastructure, including the LUMI supercomputer, is integrated into national research and industrial use. Data literacy campaigns, regulatory alignment with EU digital policies, and support for synthetic and open data further enhance AI readiness. Finland's emphasis on responsible data use ensures that AI development aligns with both technological innovation and European values.



Conclusion

Finland's artificial intelligence ecosystem is entering a decisive phase—building on strong governance, digital infrastructure, and strategic foresight to realize a sustainable and human-centric AI future. Anchored by the Artificial Intelligence 4.0 Programme and aligned with the EU AI Act, Finland's approach reflects its national values of openness, trust, and technological sovereignty. By embedding AI into broader industrial, environmental, and digital policy goals, Finland aims to become a “winner of the twin transition”—addressing both green and digital imperatives.

Key programmes such as the National Digital Compass, public-private initiatives like GAIA-X-aligned data ecosystems, and compute infrastructure exemplified by the LUMI supercomputer collectively establish Finland's strategic groundwork. These initiatives position AI not only as a technological tool but as a lever for clean industry, public sector transformation, and social equity.

Yet, pressing challenges remain. Despite high scores in government readiness and data infrastructure (84.86 and 83.73 respectively), Finland's relatively modest technology score (60.86) underscores the need to accelerate the scale-up of commercial AI applications—particularly among SMEs. Barriers include limited AI adoption in smaller firms, talent shortages in applied engineering roles, and uneven regional digital maturity. Bridging these gaps will require more robust support mechanisms—such as regulatory sandboxes, AI experimentation environments, and better integration of vocational AI training. Finland's legal and regulatory framework is evolving in step with the EU AI Act, but the operationalisation of this legislation remains a work in progress. A national working group has been tasked with drafting legal amendments and defining supervisory responsibilities, yet a dedicated AI regulator is still forthcoming. In the interim, entities like the Office of the Data Protection Ombudsman are expected to play a central role in enforcing ethical and legal compliance, particularly in high-risk AI sectors.

To maintain public trust and social legitimacy, Finland emphasizes participatory governance and transparency. Networks like VAHTI support responsible public sector AI, while strategic foresight tools—such as OKR-based goal tracking—ensure ongoing adaptability. Still, more institutionalised mechanisms for stakeholder engagement, citizen feedback, and ethical oversight will be necessary as AI deployment scales. Finland's commitment to inclusive innovation is another strategic strength. Through initiatives like Talent Boost and multidisciplinary AI education, the country is investing in a diverse AI-capable workforce. However, challenges persist in ensuring equitable access to AI resources, particularly for rural regions and non-tech sectors. Scaling SME support, reducing adoption complexity, and improving inter-agency coordination will be essential for closing these gaps.

Internationally, Finland plays a catalytic role in shaping AI norms and interoperability standards. As a vocal advocate for democratic, sustainable AI within the EU, OECD, and UNESCO, Finland is well-positioned to lead in areas such as edge computing, data stewardship, and emissions-conscious AI design. The proposed ELLIS node in Finland would further enhance global knowledge exchange and attract world-class talent. In sum, Finland's AI strategy is coherent, values-driven, and institutionally well-grounded—but now must pivot decisively from planning to execution. The foundations are robust: cross-sectoral collaboration, forward-looking infrastructure, and EU-aligned governance. With sharper focus on scale, experimentation, and market uptake, Finland can move from being a thoughtful AI adopter to a bold global standard-setter in human-aligned, sustainable AI systems.

The strategy is sound. The time to accelerate action is now.





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